



Origin of the Move

The OFM: a public scalp model built on aggression, absorption, and the refill clock. The mechanics, the entries, and the honest numbers behind them.



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READ THIS FIRST

The language, in plain English

Aggression: a market order that crosses the spread to get filled now, accepting a worse price for immediacy. It shows intent and urgency to continue price.

Effort vs result: the core read. Heavy aggression that moves price has result. Heavy aggression that doesn't is exhaustion.

Aggression memory: price remembers where aggression traded. The research paper's "level memory" is the measured version of this.

Squeeze catalyst: the cluster of absorbed aggression that sets the squeeze up. You draw it at the lowest (or highest) first aggression.

OFM: Origin of the Move. The squeeze fails, and you enter on the re-squeeze after that failure.

R: result in risk units. Risk \$80 and make \$240, that is +3R.
Lose the stop, that is -1R.

Absorption: aggressive orders being soaked up by passive orders on the other side. Lots of effort, no movement.

Aggression testing: price returning to an old area of aggression to see if those participants still act. Break through it and they have no result.

Squeeze: repeated aggressive orders getting absorbed, then releasing in one fast move. Watch the speed of tape when it goes.

Refill clock: aggressive with no result becomes aggressive with result. The orders that failed reload the next attempt.

Speed of tape: how fast prints are hitting. It spikes when a squeeze releases and dies when one fails passively.

Feature set: a variable in your model. Refill orders are the feature set this paper's numbers test.



01

What this model is

Most order-flow tools are noise to a beginner. The DOM, the footprint, the heat map: they show you everything at once, they're hard to read, and they fake you out constantly. So the first decision behind this model is to throw most of that away and read one thing: **aggressive orders**, drawn as bubbles on the chart, sized by the contracts that actually traded.

The second decision cuts against how squeezes are usually taught. Everyone wants to buy the squeeze. But if you look at the statistics, the squeeze fails often. The OFM is the trade on the other side of that: **let the first squeeze fail, then enter on the re-squeeze**. The failure is not the problem. The failure is the setup.

This PDF is the mechanics: what aggression looks like, how the refill clock works, where the entries and the stop go, and real trades walked through start to finish. The statistics behind it live in the companion research paper, *The Refill Effect*, which tested this feature set on 199 million ticks and published the losing quarter along with the winning ones, free at kanji.org.uk. The numbers that matter from it are in the back half of this document.

The squeeze fails often. That is not the problem with the trade.
That is the trade.

One thing before any of it, because the whole model leans on it: none of this replaces the higher-timeframe thesis. The auction narrative, the volume profile location, the objectives: that is what supplies direction. I tested this feature set without the thesis behind it and it is basically a coin flip. With the thesis aligned, the numbers you'll see later in this paper hold. Keep that order of operations. Thesis first, mechanics second.

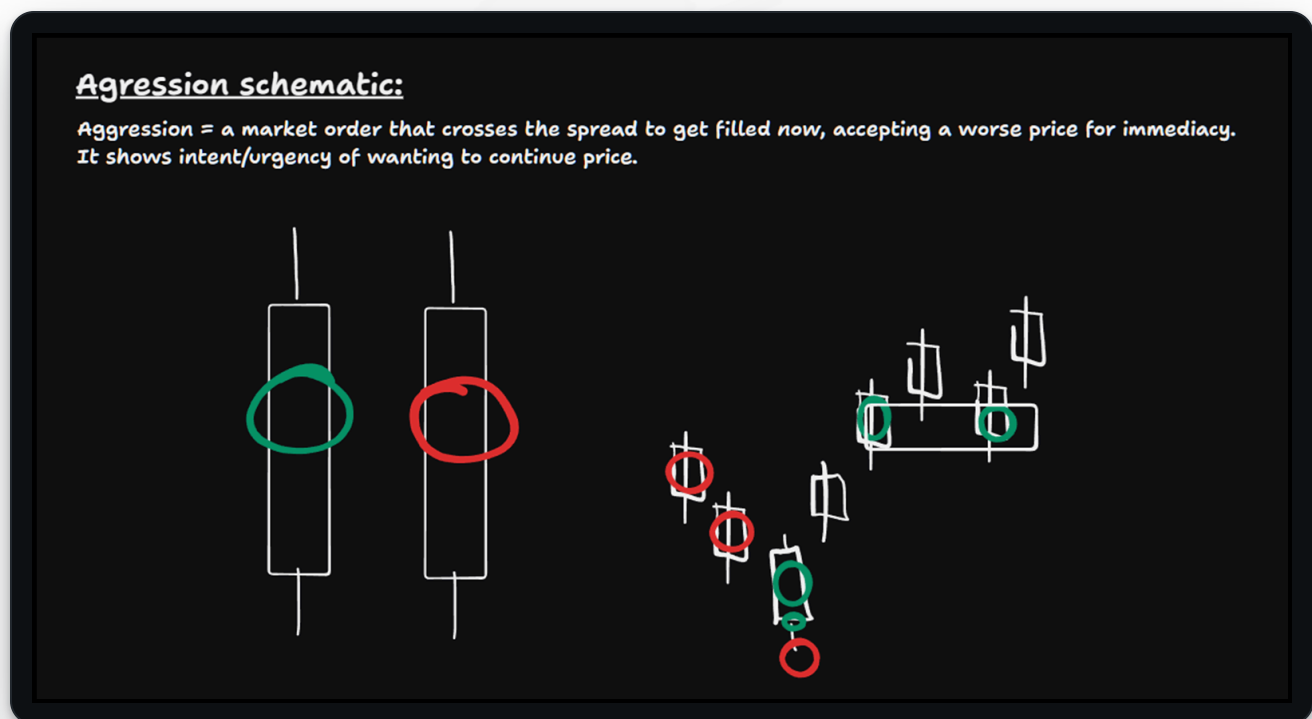


02 Aggression

An aggressive order is a market order that crosses the spread to get filled now, accepting a worse price for immediacy. That worse price is the tell: someone is paying up because they want price to continue, and they want it now. On my chart these print as bubbles. During New York AM on NASDAQ I filter to a minimum of 30 contracts and a maximum of 60 per print, and I adjust with the session's volume.

Where the bubble sits decides what it means. **Inside the body of a candle** is the most blatant form of aggression: the order pushed price and got its result. **On the wick** is the opposite story: that aggression got absorbed, passive orders on the other side soaked it up, and the level refused to move. Same bubble, opposite meaning, and the difference is nothing more than effort versus result.

The aggression schematic, from the video



Left: the two directions of aggression, a buy print and a sell print circled on the candle bodies. Right: the same read applied to a turn, sell aggression with result on the way down, buy aggression absorbing at the low, and the boxed aggression getting retested later.

Two follow-on reads complete the picture. **Aggression testing:** when price comes back to an old area of aggression, watch whether those participants act again. If price cuts through and closes beyond it, they have no result, and price usually continues until it finds the next area of aggression. And **aggression memory:** price remembers where aggression traded. That is not a slogan; it is the single strongest family of features in the research paper's model, and you'll see the number later.

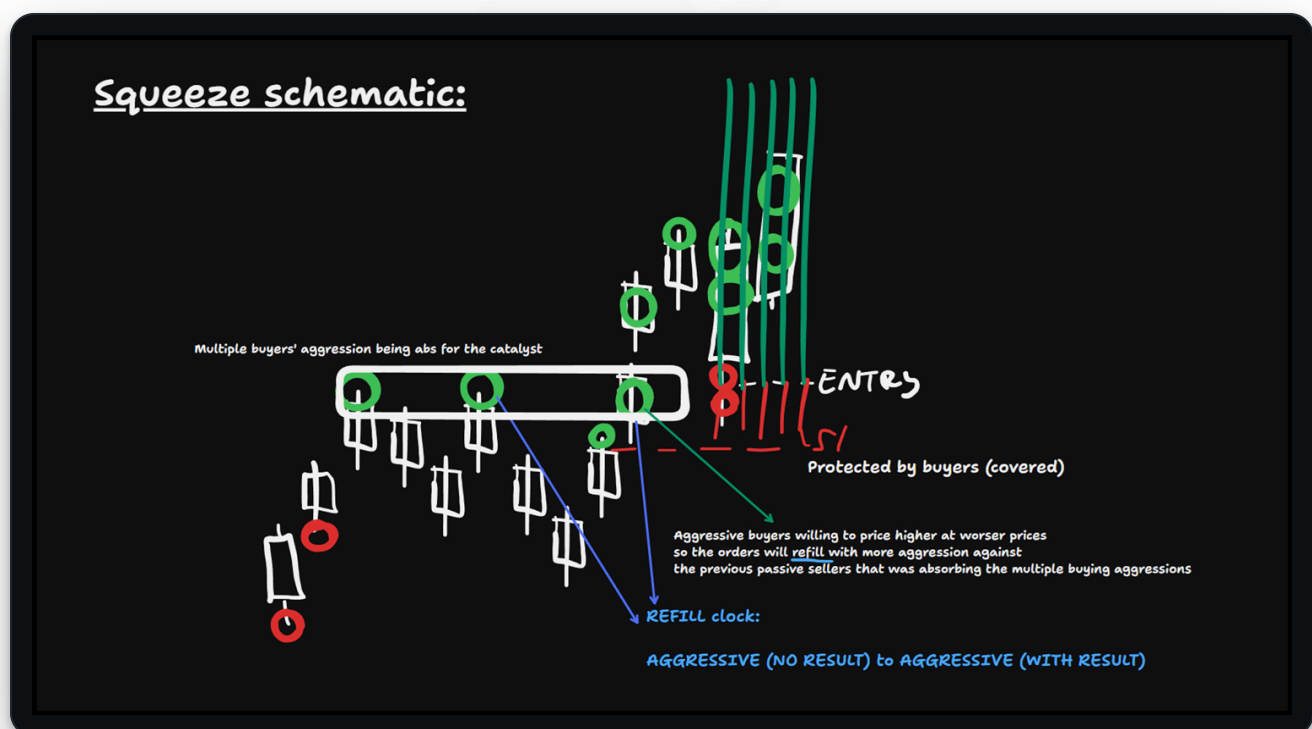


03 The squeeze and the refill clock

A squeeze starts with aggression that gets nothing. Buyers hit the market repeatedly and get absorbed, over and over, at the same area. Most people read that as weakness. It's the opposite: that cluster of absorbed aggression is the **squeeze catalyst**, because every one of those failed orders is still there, waiting to reload.

That reload is the **refill clock**, and it is the engine of this whole model: **aggressive with no result becomes aggressive with result**. The buyers who were absorbed refill into the next attempt, more aggression joins them at worse prices (which is itself proof of intent), the passive sellers who were doing the absorbing get eaten, and price releases in one fast move. Watch the speed of tape when it happens. A real squeeze is violent and quick, and you will not mistake it for drift.

The squeeze schematic, from the video



The boxed cluster is multiple buyers' aggression being absorbed: the catalyst. The refill clock turns it into the squeeze: aggressive (no result) to aggressive (with result). The entry on a plain squeeze sits where the reload happens, protected by the buyers underneath.

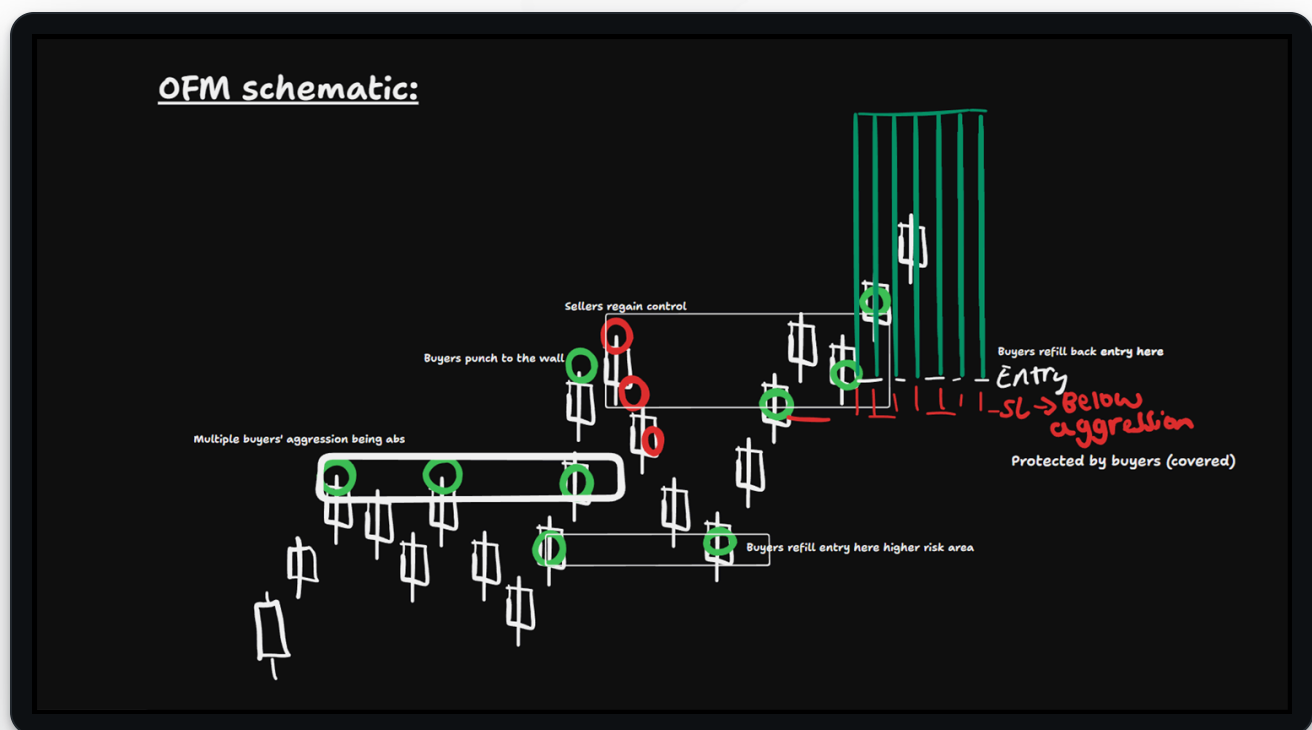
If squeezes always worked, that entry would be the whole model. They don't, and the statistics say so. Which is exactly where the OFM begins.



04 The origin of the move

The full sequence, reading the schematic below left to right. Buyers' aggression gets absorbed: the catalyst. The squeeze attempt releases, buyers punch to the wall, and this time the wall wins: sellers regain control and price rolls back through the catalyst area. Most traders write the idea off right there. What actually happened is that the failed squeeze told you exactly where the real participation lives, because the refill clock hasn't stopped. Buyers refill below (a higher-risk early entry if you want it), price comes back up, sellers get their turn at no result, and the re-squeeze goes with buyers refilled behind it.

The OFM schematic: the whole model on one slide



Two entries are marked. The early refill entry is higher risk, higher reward. The main entry comes on the re-squeeze after the failure, with the stop loss below the aggression that built it, protected by the buyers who refilled. That stop rule is not decoration: below the aggression is the point where the read is simply wrong.

THE ENTRY

On the re-squeeze, after the first squeeze fails and price retests the failure area. Earlier refill entries exist but carry more risk; they are marked on the schematic for completeness, not as the default.

THE STOP AND THE TARGET

Stop below the aggression (or above it, for shorts). Targets are discretionary and come from the higher-timeframe thesis; as a scalp model, 1R to 3R is the working zone, and trailing handles the rest.



05

On the chart

Four live walkthroughs from the video, graded honestly. This first one is a B+ on purpose: you will take more B+ setups than perfect ones, and the read is the same.

Example 1: a B+ short on the 40-range chart



The circled prints are buyers willing to price in, getting exhausted into the catalyst. The white box marks the failed-squeeze area, and the bracket on screen is the live trade: 27 ticks risked for 40.

SETUP AND CONFIRMATION

Buyers keep pricing in and keep getting absorbed into the catalyst. On the return to the failure area, sellers keep their result: the refill clock has flipped in their favor.

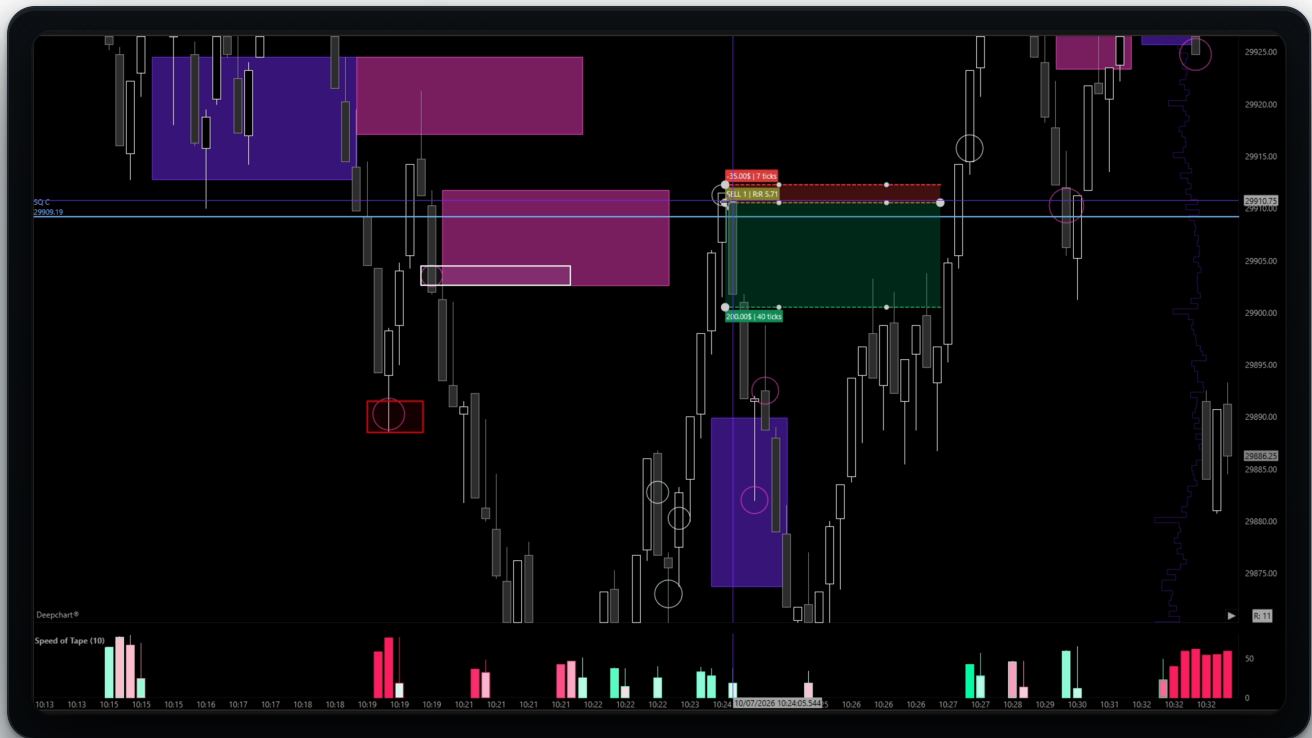
ENTRY AND RISK

Short on the retest of the failed squeeze, stop above the sellers' aggression. Where the aggression fails is where the read is wrong, so that is where the stop lives.



A cleaner short, entry bracket on

Example 2: the retest of failed sell aggression



Sellers willing to price lower, the catalyst drawn at the lowest aggression, and the entry bracket sitting on the retest. The red circle low-left marks the aggression that started the squeeze.

SETUP AND CONFIRMATION

The squeeze releases fast (the speed of tape spikes with it), then fails back above the catalyst. Sellers hitting a wall into passive buyers is the confirmation to wait for.

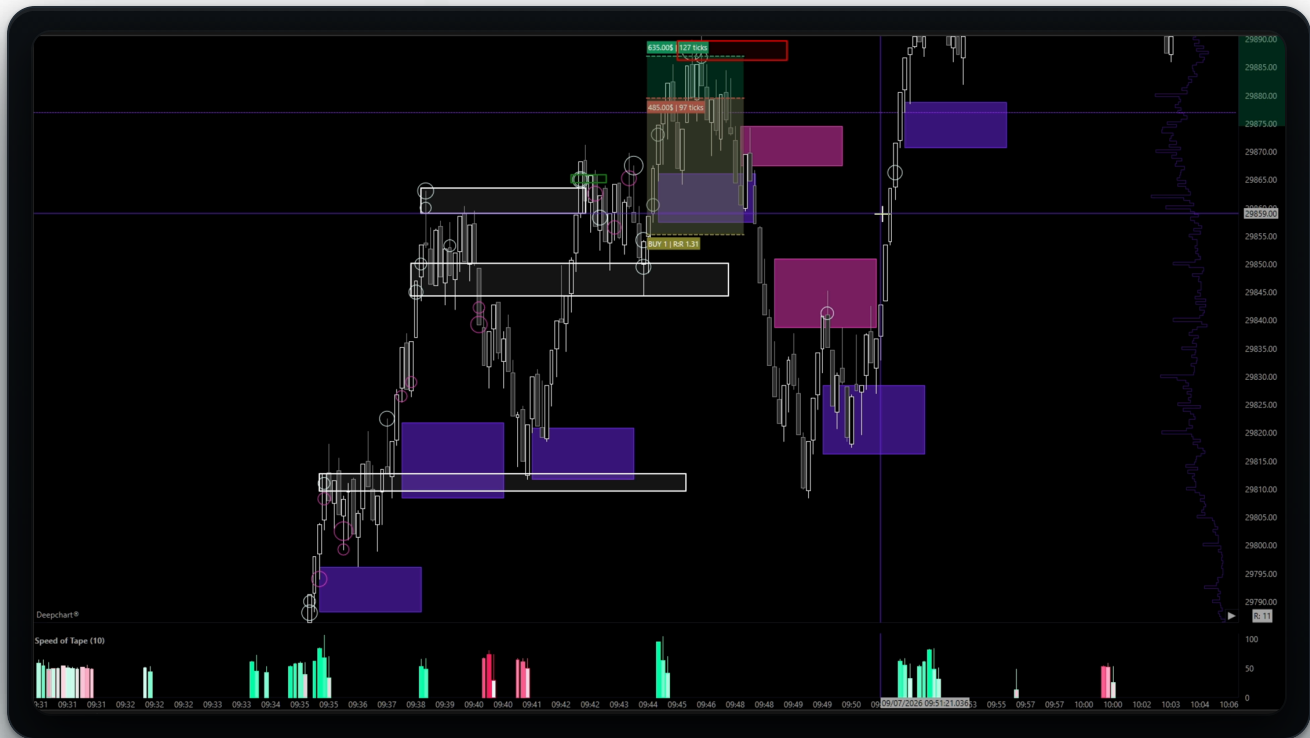
ENTRY AND RISK

Entry on the retest of the sell aggression with the stop just above it. The target is discretionary and comes from the thesis, not from the pattern.



The A+ long

Example 3: an uptrend OFM, completed



The completed trade: entry bracket top-left, the white boxes marking where buyers' aggression was absorbed and retested on the way up.

SETUP AND CONFIRMATION

Buyers get absorbed while willing to price higher. Price crossing above old sell aggression converts that past participation into passive support underneath. The punch to the wall gets no reward, and the pullback lands in the area buyers controlled.

ENTRY, RISK, AND EXIT

Entry on the buy aggression returning into that area, stop at the low or below the aggression. Trail until buyers hit a wall and get fully absorbed: that absorption is the exit.



The A+ short, drawn out

Example 4: the whole sequence in one red path



The red path traces the model end to end; the circles mark the aggression that defines each turn.

SETUP AND CONFIRMATION

Buyers hit the wall and get absorbed, sellers regain control. The squeeze lower punches into a wall twice and gets no reward either time. No result, twice, from the same participants is as loud as the tape gets.

ENTRY AND RISK

The entry is the failure of the squeeze, where sellers step back in with result. Stop above the aggression that failed.

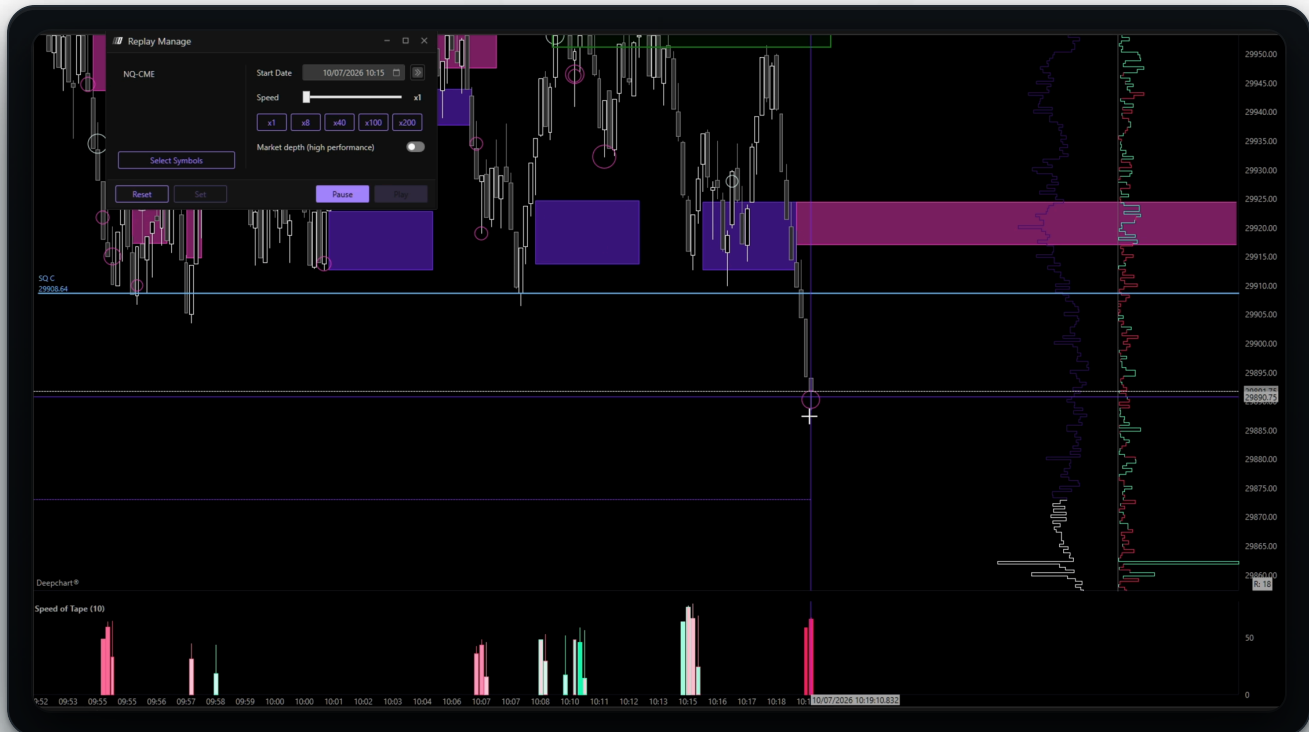


06

In replay, start to finish

Replay mode at 1x speed: the market as it actually comes, no scrubbing. One aggressive OFM short across the next three pages, setup to target.

The setup: squeeze fails, wait for the reclaim



Balance with absorption on both sides, sellers holding control. The catalyst is marked; the squeeze fails fast lower and sellers punch straight into passive buyers.

THE READ

Inside a balance a squeeze can go either way; it depends who is most in control. Sellers are, so the squeeze lower is the expectation, and its failure is the setup.

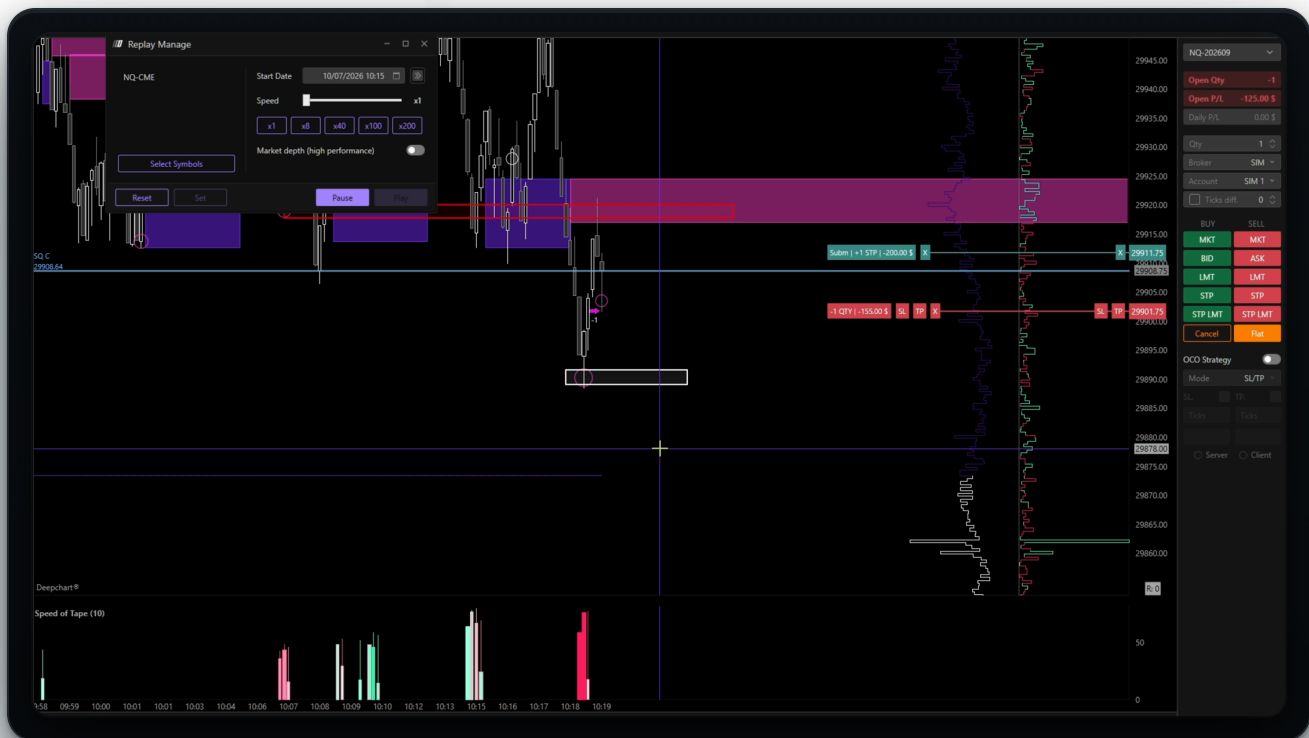
THE RULE

No short until price reclaims above the catalyst and fails again. Patience here is the trade.



The entry

Resting below the wick, tagged in by aggression



Filled short one contract; the bracket is live on the ladder, and the white box below marks the retest area the entry came from.

WHY A STOP-LIMIT

The order rests below the wick so only aggressive continuation can tag it in. If sellers don't come with result, there is no fill and no trade. The order type is doing the filtering.

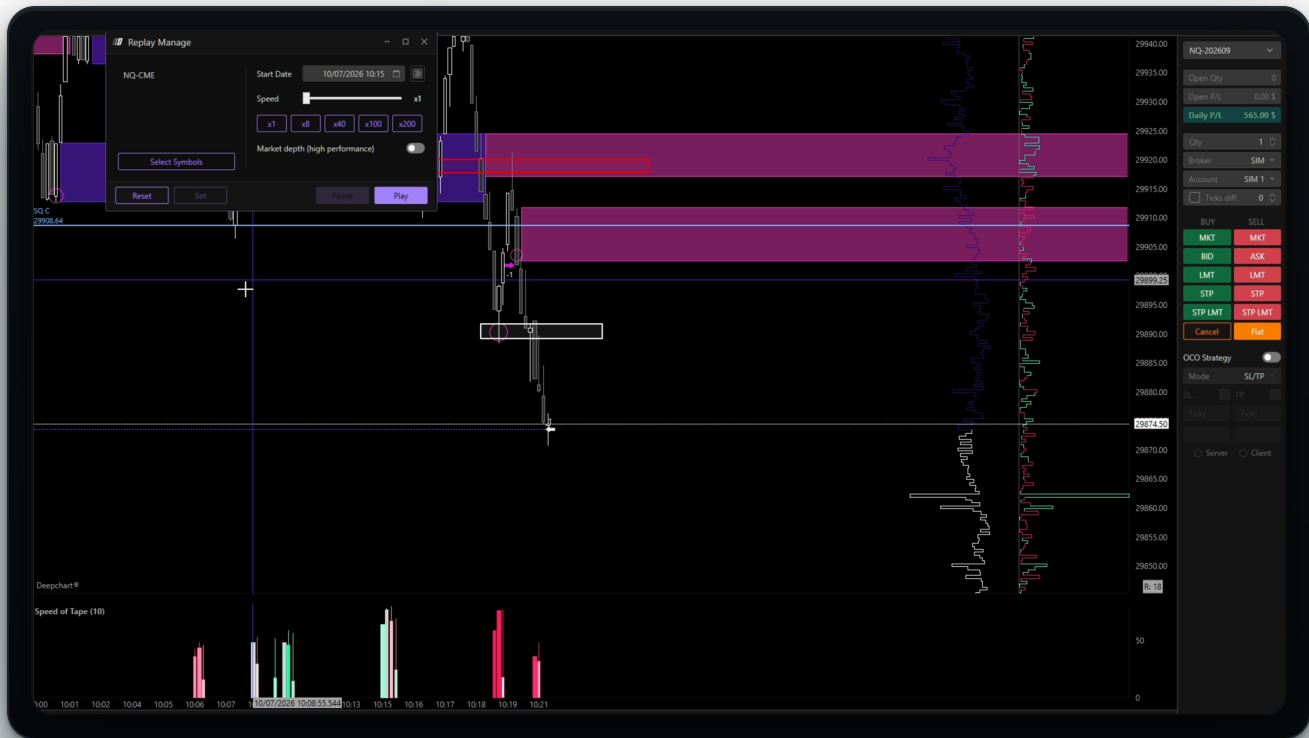
THE RISK

Stop above the intermediate wick. If it stops out, fine: the re-entry sits right below, and the read has not changed.



The exit

Trailing convexity to the objective



The stop has walked down above each new pocket of aggression as price breaks lower; the trade runs into the higher-timeframe objective from the daily profile and takes profit there.

TRAILING CONVEXITY

Cut the loss branch off while the win branch keeps running. Each new aggression pocket that forms below gives the stop a new home above it. The full trailing rule set is its own lesson inside the mentorship, and the 7 day free trial includes it.

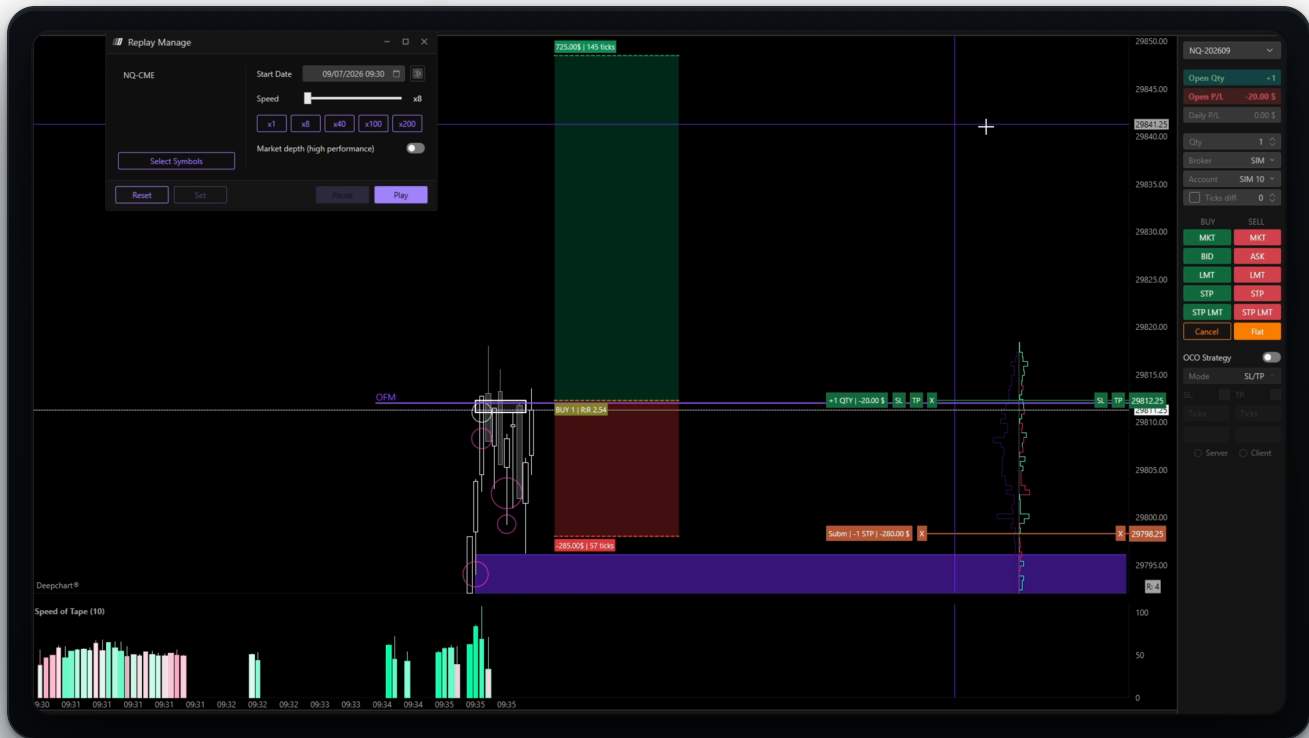
WHERE THE TARGET CAME FROM

The thesis, not a feeling: the objective was the value area of the daily profile, set before the trade existed.



The passive variant

No aggression needed at the failure



The second replay trade, long this time, at take-profit. The squeeze failed passively and the entry triggered above the buyers.

THE READ

The squeeze fails with no aggressive orders at the failure at all: the speed of tape just dies. The absence of result is itself the signal, and it is the quieter, more common version of this model.

ENTRY AND RISK

Entry above the buyers, stop below the aggression, scalp target in the 1R to 3R zone. Same model, passive edition.



07 The numbers behind the model

Everything in this chapter comes from *The Refill Effect*: 199 million ticks of NQ and MNQ, 235 sessions, 41,152 zone-touch events, tested the way an academic would test it, placebos and all. It is not a separate idea from the mechanics you just read. It is the same read (a level, a return, a decision about whether the defenders are still there) run through machinery that cannot lie to itself.

Start with the finding that cuts against this model's own branding. When the paper decomposed its model to see which features did the work, raw order flow alone (delta into the touch, approach speed, imbalance) barely beat a coin flip: AUC 0.54. The families that carried the signal were **memory** (has this zone been defended before) and **location** (is it at a real auction edge). Aggression builds the level. It is the level's history that predicts the next touch. That is your aggression memory, measured.

Second: selection is what flips the sign. Fade every touch of every level with no filter and you lose **-0.285R per trade** after costs, because only 42% of touches hold. Grade each touch first (has it held, was it built by size, where does it sit) and take only the best and it flips to **+0.143R per trade**, out-of-sample, on 79 sessions the model never saw. Same concept. The only thing that changed is which touches you take.

Third, the detail that matters most at the DOM: the median eventual winner dips **18 ticks past the touch** before it works. The defence does not happen at the front edge of the level. It happens inside it, where the refill actually reloads. If you act the instant price tags the level, you are acting at the exact point where the data says the trade has not started yet. And execution style decides everything downstream of that: identical signals, same engine, resting a limit inside the zone made a 1.80 profit factor while chasing with market orders made 0.81 and lost money.

Aggression builds the level. **The level's memory pays the trade.**



08 The playbook

People hear "you need alpha" in this space constantly, and it stops them before they start. Here is the correction: inside a prop structure you do not need alpha. Real standalone alpha takes years and a maths PhD to manufacture. A prop evaluation is a barrier problem: reach the target before the trailing drawdown reaches you. What that rewards is a positive (even neutral) expectancy edge with the right **risk geometry**. That, this feature set has. So the playbook below is not "how to beat the market." It is how to convert a thin, real edge into passed evaluations and payouts.

FINDING	WHAT IT TELLS YOU TO DO
Memory + location carry the signal; flow alone is AUC 0.54	Before acting on a level, ask if it has held before and if it sits at a real auction edge. A big print with no history and no location is not a graded setup yet.
Fading everything loses $-0.285R$; selecting flips it to $+0.143R$	Wait for the second test, or for memory, construction, and location to agree. The first touch of a fresh zone is the weakest version of this trade.
Median winner dips 18 ticks past the touch	Rest the order inside the zone, not at its edge. The research config rests 12 ticks in with a 32-tick stop; the depth matters less than the principle.
Limit inside the zone: PF 1.80. Market at the touch: PF 0.81	Be the order that gets filled by the flush, not the order that pays the spread to chase it.
A $-4R$ daily stop adds ~ 14 points of eval pass rate	Cap the bad day mechanically. This one rule moved the needle more than any parameter in the whole study.
Payout is capped near \$2k per cycle by the trailing drawdown	Do not out-size the cap. Three staggered accounts make at least one payout a near-certainty; scale by count, not by risk.

Each row's left column is a measured result from the research paper; the right column is the behavioral translation. None of it is an entry signal, and all of it assumes the thesis is already behind the trade. The thesis is the first thing the trial teaches.



Every number, with its caveat attached

STATISTIC	VALUE	CAVEAT
THE RAW CONCEPT		
Touches that hold, unfiltered	42%	base rate, not a trading rule
Fade every touch	-0.285R/trade	after modelled costs; nobody should run this
SELECTION		
Touch grading, out-of-sample	AUC 0.63	modest by design; placebo scores 0.51
Hold rate, worst to best decile	25% → 63%	monotonic, but historical buckets
Order flow alone	AUC 0.54	memory + location do the real work
EXECUTION / THE REFILL		
Median winner's dip past the touch	18 ticks	a median; queues can be less kind live
Resting limit, Q1, independent engine	68.8% / PF 1.80 / +\$2,112	64 trades, one quarter, engine we didn't build
Market order, same signals	27.2% / PF 0.81 / -\$405	proves the execution effect, nothing more
OUT-OF-SAMPLE RECORD		
79 held-out sessions	+0.143R, PF 1.19, +78R	542 trades; one regime slice of one year
Independent engine, full year	+\$3,803, PF 1.45, ≈+0.07R	stricter fills; the conservative quote
Worst quarter (most recent)	-\$647, PF 0.76	disclosed and counted, not trimmed
ROBUSTNESS		
Reverse split / rotating folds	+0.14R to +0.22R	AUC 0.61 to 0.64; still one dataset
Parameter grid, train vs test	rank corr 0.92	a plateau, not proof any setting works
PROP ECONOMICS (TOPSTEP-STYLE 50K, 4,000-PATH MONTE CARLO, -4R DAILY STOP)		
Pass at \$60 / \$80 / \$100 per R	96.7% / 92.2% / 85.7%	simulation on historical dailies, not live-forward
-4R daily stop	+14 pts pass rate	the largest single lever found
First payout at \$80/R	95.5%	payout capped ≈\$2k/cycle by the trailing DD
Three staggered accounts	P(≥1 payout) ≈ 99.6%	assumes independence and the edge persisting

All figures are historical simulation after modelled costs, from *The Refill Effect* (Ethos Order Flow Research, 2026).
Educational statistics, not a promise of future performance.



09 What the numbers do not give you

This is the page a highlight reel would skip, so read it twice.

There is no mechanical entry signal in here. When the entry was rebuilt from scratch and tested causally, with every trace of hindsight stripped out, it came back negative: on the order of $-0.16R$ to $-0.54R$ out-of-sample. The earlier version that looked profitable had quietly used information from later in the day to pick which setup was "the one." Remove that peek and the mechanical edge disappears. What survives is a grading system for touches you have already found, and an execution rule about which side of the book to stand on.

The thesis is not optional. I tested this feature set without the higher-timeframe narrative behind it, and on its own it is basically a coin flip. The auction bias, the profile location, the objectives: that is what supplies direction, and it is the only reason the refill read works at all. Every pass rate on the previous page assumes the thesis is already aligned. If you skip that part, you are not trading this model; you are flipping coins with extra steps.

The edge is thin and it lives on discipline. $+0.143R$ per trade in the research replay, roughly half that on the stricter independent engine, and a losing quarter already sits in the record. A thin edge survives on the $-4R$ daily stop, the sizing, and the patience to wait for graded setups. It does not survive a trader who overrides it.

Everything here is historical simulation after modelled costs. It describes what was. Nothing in this document is financial advice, and no number in it promises a future result.





The mechanics find the trade. The thesis gives it **direction**.

This PDF is lesson 01 of Micro-Mechanics, and it is the only public one. The rest of the playlist lives in the lifetime tier. The trial gets you the part this model cannot work without: the thesis videos, the live sessions three mornings a week, and the full archive. Page 18 told you what these mechanics are worth without the thesis. The first trial videos are the thesis, so start there. Seven days, everything unlocked.

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